

CSS Rules and Concepts Cheat Sheet

1. Media queries respond to viewport size; container queries respond to parent container size.
2. text-wrap: balance tries to balance line lengths.
3. Logical properties adapt automatically to writing direction.
4. Inline elements ignore width and height unless their display changes.
5. Span is an inline element; div is a block element.
6. Margin auto horizontally centers block elements with a constrained width.
7. Top/right/bottom/left only affect positioned elements.
8. Absolute positioning is relative to the nearest positioned ancestor.
9. Fixed positioning is relative to the viewport.
10. Sticky behaves like relative until its threshold, then like fixed within its scroll container.
11. Transforms affect visual rendering but not normal document flow.
12. Transforms create a new stacking context in many cases.
13. Transitions animate only when a property value changes.
14. Animations can run automatically without user interaction.
15. Flexbox is one-dimensional; Grid is two-dimensional.
16. justify-content aligns items along the main axis; align-items along the cross axis.
17. Pseudo-classes style an existing element in a state; pseudo-elements style a generated part of an element.
18. ::before and ::after require content to generate boxes.
19. box-shadow does not affect layout size.
20. outline does not take up space; border does.
21. CSS variables inherit like normal properties unless redefined.
22. Custom properties are resolved when used, enabling theme switching.
23. Dark mode is commonly implemented by changing custom property values.
24. z-index only applies to positioned elements and certain layout items.
25. Overflow clipping can hide absolutely positioned descendants.
26. Grid gap creates spacing without adding margins.
27. Percentage padding is based on the containing block's width.